GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

January 16th, 2026
Week 3
Volume 280, Issue 1219

Highlights:

- **Marble-chasing.**
- **Turbulent times.**
- **VL market firing.**
- **Price wobbles.**
- **Demand rising.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"True humility is not thinking less of yourself; it is thinking of yourself less."

– Unknown

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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REVERBERATIONS!

Post–New Year developments and shocking events have continued to send reverberations across the markets, directly and indirectly, following the surreal extrication of President Maduro and his wife from Venezuela under Trump's orders — with clear intentions around the country's oil riches — followed by his marble-chasing claims over Greenland that are based on similarly wet-spaghetti logic, which has since sparked a serious fallout with several European and even Canadian leaders to match. What a time to be a witness.

In the meantime, S&P markets saw at least one buyer in particular, who has been making some major plays on VLCC assets as secondhand values show few signs of deterioration — and the Baltic Exchange Dry Index echoed just that this week as it halted a nine-session slide to mark a 2.3% U-turn, climbing to 1,567 points. This was driven by gains across segments: Capes (up 2.3%), Panamax (up 4.3%), and the smaller segments adding four points by week's end. Notably, the overall benchmark index still finished the week down 7.2%. Oil too continued to trip on itself and stayed below the coveted USD 60/barrel mark despite a 0.4% increase, closing the week out at USD 59.44/barrel.

The U.S. Dollar meanwhile dominated **all** ship recycling currencies this week, while local steel plate prices across destinations dissolved into a mixed bag of opposing moves — both competitively and historically (i.e., versus last week).

As such, ship recycling markets may be continue to deprived of tonnage as hopes for a brighter start to 2026 — indicated by the tapering indices back in November – December 2025 — begin to fade once again. Prices across the Indian sub-continent have meanwhile continued their own song and dance on a downward path over the last month, with dry bulk indications at the bidding tables regularly below USD 400/LDT and several sales reportedly even being concluded in the USD 370s–USD 380s/LDT range.

Across destinations, India briefly surged by about USD 30/LDT before losing the full move the very next week as fundamentals softened. Pakistan's demand has begun to show, with end buyers now increasingly hungry to fill plots as empty anchorages become more of the norm than the exception. Bangladeshi recyclers have largely been on the lookout for particular units based on their recent appetites as local offerings have helped them bounce back to the top of the market rankings again. And Turkey? A bevy of European RoRos finally arrived Aliaga this week, delivering much-needed sustenance to an ailing local industry.

Overall, the interim / near-future still looks like a quiet one – maybe not for Turkey? That'd a switch.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 3 of 2026 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

GOING BIG!

Buyers looking.

For as satiated as the Chattogram market has been of late - given its healthy set of deliveries in late November and even the last couple of weeks, including this one, where at least one decent LDT tanker arrived locally – local ship recyclers are clearly becoming available for the right kind of tonnage - and that too at the best levels in the industry. However, this recent interest is deviating towards mostly larger LDT units like LNGs, tankers, and dry vessels such as capes (if any do come available).

Reluctant for small.

With prices to match and as determined as tier-1 local buyers tend to be, indications surfacing this week have helped push Bangladesh into the top spot of the market rankings yet again. So, now you know, if you've got a large LDT hulker regardless of type, now's as good a time as any to get in on it.

Notwithstanding the limited spectrum of resurging optimism, this improvement has puzzlingly arrived at a peculiar time when inflation has risen from 8.29% in November to 8.49% in December and prices across the board (food, housing, utilities, furnishings, etc.) have risen of late. This was followed on by a local steel plate price that tanked USD 12/Ton this week and end at about USD 487/ton, which was accompanied by a declining Bangladeshi Taka that lost also 12 basis points to the U.S. Dollar and conclude the week at BDT 122.40 – one of the higher levels we have seen of late.

Elections loom.

Moreover, as violence continues to mar the streets of the capital city Dhaka, amid escalating attacks that saw two newspaper offices become the latest victims, election fever has clearly been ramping up along with local agitation and its effects on day-to-day life. Blended into the mix is the domestic economy, making it a commendable feat to witness the resilience of the Chattogram Choppers at the bidding tables, week after week.

On the heels

Overall, while this market stands open and willing to engage in serious discussions on tonnage, there remains an overall reluctance to engage in small(er) LDT units, which have been increasingly diverted Westward. Smaller, poor(er) condition bulkers are also seeing lower rates here, as well as the entire sub-continent, as a few recent fixtures well below USD 400/LDT come to light.

With the critical election looming on the horizon on February 12th, Bangladeshi buyers need to remain alert enough to snap up their share of any of the slim pickings of the right vessels that may make an appearance before the elections, especially **if** the wrong choice of leader is elected (any recent elections affecting the world grab attention?), and as Pakistan and India still remain on their heels.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

CURIOUS WEEKS!

It has been a curious 2026 in India thus far, with steel plate prices and local offerings surging by nearly USD 30/LDT at the start of the year, only to find themselves tumbling down the very next week by nearly the same number and spectacularly lose any gains that may have otherwise been realized, leaving owners and cash buyers with little chance to gauge the way of the pricing winds from Alang in the coming week(s).

Back down.

And domestic fundamentals have certainly been to blame as they have been on an absolute bender of late, given that local steel plate prices reclaimed USD 11/ton this week (having lost USD 24/ton just the week prior) and clock out at USD 410/Ton. The Indian Rupee meanwhile lost over 0.55% and welcomed the weekend at Rs. 90.72 – approaching the psychological boundary of Rs. 91 once again. Should that come to fruition, ever-nervy local recyclers will find themselves promptly reassessing their offerings,

Rupee woes.

The only rainbow on the otherwise grey horizon was the arrival of 3 new vessels at Alang's waterfront this week, including an over 16K LDT tanker. Hopefully, all were concluded at levels safe enough to keep their deals in the green (or out of the red at the very least).

Domestic inflation has meanwhile managed to climb out of stagflation territory from 0.71% back in November and ring the New Year in at 1.33%, clearly inching into healthier zones once again. And if this trend continues over the next couple of weeks, we may see fundamentals stabilize and bring prices up enough to grab some attention again, especially as the pivotal month of March (and businesses closing their books for their year) comes around.

HKC up.

Overall, Alang recyclers certainly seem ready to engage in discussions at current levels and on any tonnage – as and when it may be tabled. For now, it's clearly a "take it for what it is" situation.

Take it for what it is.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

SLAP HAPPY!

Stable offerings.

Right alongside India, Pakistan has registered a strange start to the year with hungry end buyers finding themselves shifting from 3rd place on the market rankings to the 2nd without really having changed their offer levels at all, thanks to comparatively stable offerings than what neighboring India's pricing trajectory has been of late. And while firmer levels are always welcome on the supply side of things, this has unfortunately not translated into any fresh arrivals at Gadani's waterfront so far this year.

Slow rolling.

Clearly, several items have colluded to deliver this effect viz. a lack of supply, a lack of HKC yards to engage in local competition and ensure a fair price target is achieved, and an unwillingness on part of the selling community to engage in DASR procedures, which generally result in delays at anchorage and potential loss of delivery time on what should otherwise be prompt deliveries, all while slow-rolling formalities are completed. Gadani recyclers, it would seem, are destined to enter an unintendedly slap happy phase this January 2026.

And with fundamentals playing the funk again, that local steel plate prices have resumed flatlining at USD 600/Ton, indicating a lack of local trading on account of virtually no local deliveries or generated recycled ship steel. The PKR also added to current stresses, as it too lost nearly 0.5% against the U.S. Dollar (like their Indian brethren) entering the weekend at PKR 280.

Rarely proposed.

Yet some positivity remains: Pakistan's first HKC approved yard has been welcomed into the international fraternity, and several more are reportedly set to follow in the coming month(s). Hopefully, Gadani starts to catch up to the international stage with HKC infrastructure upgrades and accreditations soon.

For now, despite its firmer offerings, we do not foresee too many (if any) of the rarely proposed units heading to local shores.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

I SEE MOVEMENT…

Smart move.

Aliaga's ship recycling sector woke up like Bigfoot in the woods, appearing out of nowhere with several sales registered to local recyclers, leaving Aliaga's anchorage earmarked over the last couple of weeks with a bunch of European RoRo's that were in the process of being delivered to their respective recyclers.

Even though import steel plate prices climbed and the Turkish Lira dropped another 31 basis points against the U.S. Dollar to close the week at TRY 43.27, local offerings are holding steady — a smart move given the possibility of a busier Q1 ahead.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 3 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	390 / LDT	410 / LDT	420 / LDT
3	India	**Declining**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

WOWZA!!

- *The Animal Welfare Act's definition of animal excludes fish, insects, cephalopods, and most mice and rats.*
- *A single weed vape can hold a whopping 5,000 milligrams of THC.*
- *In Japan, you can buy soy sauce laced with ostrich antibodies.*
- *When lettuce is contaminated with E. coli, washing it doesn't do much good.*
- *Any inanimate object is fundamentally just a collection of atoms; a living organism might be better understood as a dynamic pattern playing out over time.*
- *A prescription-only system on an AppleWatch can detect if the wearer is having a nightmare. It vibrates enough to stop the bad dream but not enough to wake them.*
- *In 1999, a vegetative patient suddenly started talking after being put on Ambien.*
- *Saturn's official moon count nearly doubled this year after scientists confirmed the discovery of 128 new satellites.*
- *Olive Garden's signature "Tour of Italy" dish has 3,200 milligrams of sodium—more than double what the American Heart Association considers an optimal daily amount for adults.*
- *Ounce for ounce, turkey contains less tryptophan—an amino acid popularly blamed for post-Thanksgiving sleepiness—than cheddar cheese or an octopus does.*
- *One AI start-up spent $1.8 million to purchase the URL friend.com.*
- *Calling a loved one by their name makes some people feel anxious or nauseated.*
- *LinkedIn has a "Videos for You" tab that essentially turns the app into corporate TikTok.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
January 26 – Republic Day **No holidays in February**	January 17 – January 24 January 30 – February 06 February 16 – February 23

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No Holidays in January February 21 – Martyr's Day	January 21 – January 24 February 03 – February 06 February 19 – February 22

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
February 05 – Kashmir Solidarity Day February 18 – Bank Holiday	**No holidays in February**

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ALANG - Port Position as of January 16, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Bodhi*	*16,294*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered January 15*
2	*Emano 11*	*2,556*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered January 10*
3	Sheng Lu	6,311	Bulker	Arrived January 12
Morality		**25,161**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of January 16, 2026

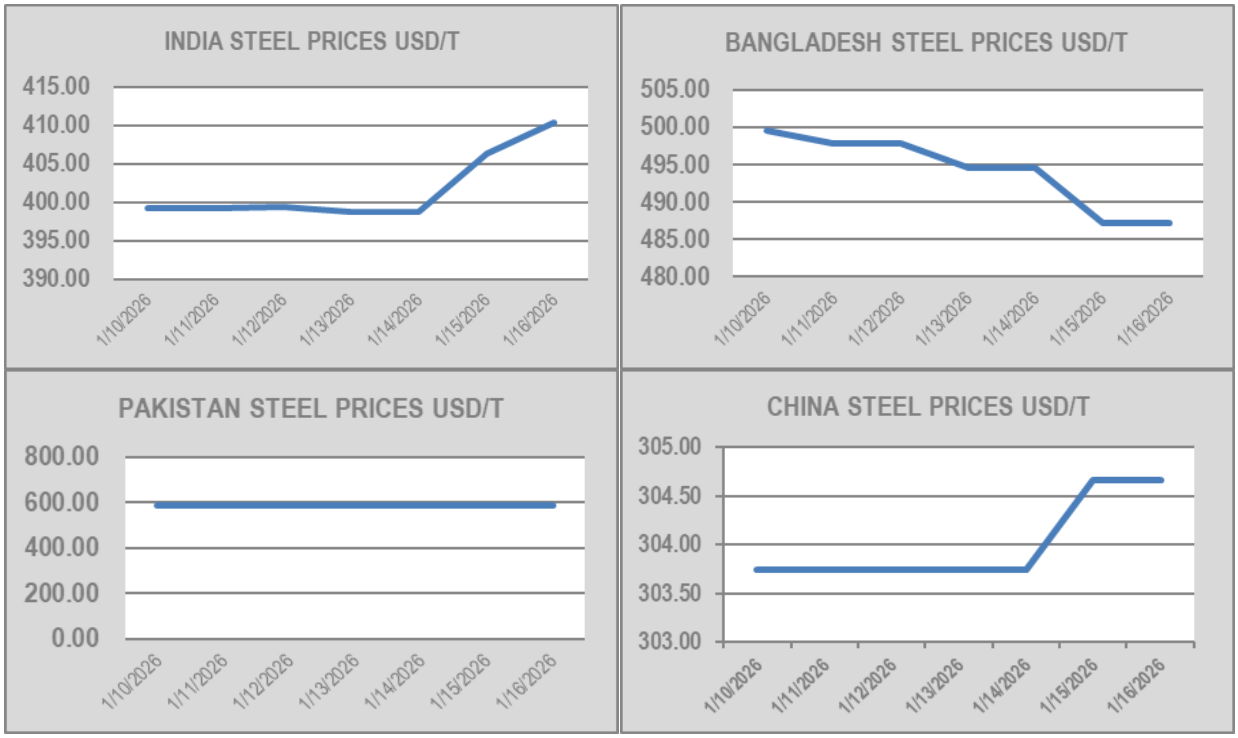
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Kohzan Maru*	*9,962*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered January 07*
		9,962		

GADANI - Port Position as of January 16, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported.		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
1/10/2026	399.25	36,000.00	586.56	165,000.00	499.59	60,700.00	303.75
1/11/2026	399.25	36,000.00	586.56	165,000.00	497.94	60,500.00	303.75
1/12/2026	399.33	36,000.00	586.56	165,000.00	497.94	60,500.00	303.75
1/13/2026	398.72	36,000.00	586.56	165,000.00	494.65	60,100.00	303.75
1/14/2026	398.72	36,000.00	586.56	165,000.00	494.65	60,100.00	303.75
1/15/2026	406.42	36,700.00	586.56	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	304.66
1/16/2026	410.32	37,200.00	586.56	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	304.66



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